IF YOU HEAR THIS

“I’m done / sitting this one out.”

This page is for when someone is frustrated and ready to sit the election out. Listen first. Talk from the heart. Don’t argue. Find the one local issue that would make it worth showing up for their family.

BASIC BRIDGE

Level 1 — Short Conversational Bridge

“A lot of people feel that way. What’s the one local result that would make it worth showing up for your family?”

EXPANDED BRIDGE

Level 2 — One-Pager

The issue

Burnout is common after years of high-volume national politics. People sit out because they feel their vote or voice does not change anything.

Short background

Locally the opposite is often true. Low turnout in precincts, school-board races, city councils, or bond elections means relatively small numbers of organized voters decide outcomes that affect taxes, safety, water, and services. When good people sit out, the decisions are still made — just by whoever shows up.

The bridge

“I get the frustration — a lot of people feel done. The catch is that when good people sit out, the decisions still get made by whoever shows up. On the issue that’s weighing on you most right now, would you be open to one small step — checking your registration, talking to one neighbor, or covering one block?” Listen, mirror, and close on that single commitment.
Ownership close: “We are the they. What’s the one thing you’ll own this month?”

EXPANDED BRIDGE

Level 3 — White Paper

Why people sit out

Repeated national cycles create fatigue. Many voters conclude that individual participation is futile because the issues that dominate media are distant from daily life. The emotional logic is understandable; the practical consequence is that local races with lower visibility are decided by smaller, more organized groups.

Supporting local context

- In many Yavapai County precincts and local contests, turnout is significantly lower than in presidential races. Small shifts in participation can change results on school boards, bonds, and municipal races that directly affect taxes, services, and growth management.
- Residents consistently name costs, housing, water with growth, and neighborhood safety as the issues that matter most. These are decided locally more than nationally.

The perspective shift

Sitting out does not stop decisions; it transfers them to whoever remains organized. The useful reframe is not “you must care about politics.” It is “the issue you already care about will still be decided — and one small action changes who decides it.” This restores a sense of agency without demanding high-volume engagement.

Ownership close

“We are the they. What’s the one block or one person you’ll cover?”

EXPANDED BRIDGE

Level 4 — 2-Minute Video Script

[Spoken, conversational pace — approximately 2 minutes]

A lot of people say, “I’m done. I’m sitting this one out.” After years of national noise, that feeling makes sense.

Here’s the bridge: “A lot of people feel that way. What’s the one local result that would make it worth showing up for your family?”

Then we point to the practical reality: when good people sit out, the decisions on costs, safety, water, and schools still get made — just by whoever shows up. We ask which local issue is weighing on them most, we listen, and we offer one small step: check registration, talk to one neighbor, or cover one block.

That’s the shift: from “nothing I do matters” to “this one thing I care about will still be decided, and I can influence who decides it.”

Neighbors talking to neighbors. We are the they.

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